

U.S. Bombers Leave a British Air Base After a Security Scare

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The U.S. Air Force has brought its bombers home from **RAF Fairford**, a U.S.-run military air base in England, the Associated Press reports. The move follows a British investigation into a suspected plan to attack the base.

RAF Fairford is about 100 miles (160 kilometers) west of London. American bombers have used it during decades of conflicts in the Middle East. Since the start of the U.S. war with Iran, aviation watchers have seen dozens of large B-52 and B-1 bombers operating from the base. On Sunday, observers noticed many B-1 bombers flying out of Fairford.

In late September, police responded to a security incident at the base. Last week, a man who holds both British and Iranian citizenship was arrested in London on suspicion of planning a terror attack. In total, six people were taken into custody during the investigation and later released on **bail**, which means they were allowed to leave custody while the investigation continues. British officials have linked the incident to Iran's government. Iran has denied that it was involved.

The bombers' departure comes as President Donald Trump weighs his next steps in the conflict with Iran, including the possibility of new strikes. When the campaign began, he had told Americans it would last only a matter of weeks.

The U.S. military still has a large presence in the Middle East. A U.S. official said the **aircraft carrier** USS Theodore Roosevelt and a group of ships carrying more than 7,000 sailors and 2,000 **Marines** are heading to the region. The official said that could mean three U.S. **aircraft carriers** in the area as early as the end of October.

Word Treasure

RAF Fairford -- A U.S.-run military air base in England.

bail -- Being allowed to leave custody while an investigation continues.

aircraft carrier -- A huge warship that carries and launches planes.

Marines -- A branch of the U.S. military that serves on land and at sea.

Break it down

Lead: bombers return home from RAF Fairford
Background on the base and recent bomber flights
The suspected attack plan and investigation
Iran's denial
Trump weighs next steps
U.S. ships head to the Middle East

Why it matters

The move shows how a security threat can change U.S. military plans abroad during an ongoing conflict with Iran.

Test what you remember

1. Which news agency reported the bombers' departure?
 - (A) NPR
 - (B) Variety
 - (C) CBC News
 - (D) The Associated Press
2. Which types of bombers have operated from RAF Fairford?
 - (A) B-52 and B-1
 - (B) Cargo jets only
 - (C) Helicopters
 - (D) F-16 and F-35
3. What citizenship does the man arrested in London hold?
 - (A) Australian
 - (B) British and Iranian
 - (C) Canadian and French
 - (D) American only
4. What happened to the six people taken into custody?
 - (A) They were released on bail
 - (B) They were sent to Iran
 - (C) They were never questioned
 - (D) They joined the Air Force
5. What had President Trump told Americans when the campaign began?
 - (A) It would end in 2030
 - (B) It would never start
 - (C) It would last only a matter of weeks
 - (D) It would last ten years
6. How many U.S. aircraft carriers could be in the region by the end of October?
 - (A) Seven
 - (B) One
 - (C) Zero
 - (D) Three

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: A 3: B 4: A 5: C 6: D

Questions to think about

1. **British officials:** Have linked the incident at the base to Tehran.
2. **Iran:** Has denied any involvement.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):